Build It Twice

CS 450: AI and the World
Building day · Wed 10/28 · 50 minutes

Goal: build one small, useful thing with AI, then improve it with a *second* tool and compare.

1. Frame and menu

5 min

Route	What you need	Good for
A. Agate with Cursor	Your UNH agate login, free Cursor account, agent set up (Sept 30 sheet)	Editing real files. *Free plan: only a few prompts, so think before you send.*
B. OpenCode with DeepThought	OpenCode set up (Oct 21 sheet) on agate or your laptop, plus your DeepThought key	Making and running a project (agate is first choice here too)
C. Your own CLI tool	Your own laptop + comfort with a terminal	People who already use one
D. Browser AI chat	A web browser, nothing to install	Anyone; always-works backup

Rules: Start where you are comfortable. Try **at least two** routes before you leave. If setup stalls, **switch to browser chat right away** and keep building. **Not building by 1:25? Switch to browser chat.**

2. Pick and pre-check

5 min

Pick **one small build** from your own field or life. **Ideas:** a tip calculator for your job · a lab-procedure checklist page · a flashcard or quiz page for a class · cleaning a small, messy CSV list · a budget tracker · a recipe scaler · a sports stats table · a study schedule maker.

My build: _____

Before you prompt, write **two checks** that prove it works. A good check is something you can *test*.

Good: "Done when I enter 3 servings for a recipe that serves 6, 2 cups of flour shows as 1 cup."

Too vague: "Done when it works." (Works how? You can't test this.)

Check 1: Done when... _____

Check 2: Done when... _____

3. Round 1: build with your first tool

20 min

> In browser chat, ask for everything in one HTML file. Save it as `mybuild.html` and double-click it to open it in your browser.

Tool used: _____

My first prompt: _____

What I got: _____

Then run your two checks. **Check 1:** ☐ pass ☐ fail ☐ partly **Check 2:** ☐ pass ☐ fail ☐ partly

4. Round 2: same project, second tool

12 min

Open a **different** tool on the **same** project. Ask it to **fix, extend, or explain** one thing. Then re-run your two checks. Opening the second tool counts in the 12 minutes.

> **Easiest pairs:** Cursor and OpenCode in the same agate folder, or chat to chat. Moving from agate to chat? Type `cat yourfile`, copy the output and paste it.

Second tool: _____

What I asked it to do: _____

_____

What changed: _____

_____

Check 1 now: ☐ pass ☐ fail ☐ partly **Check 2 now:** ☐ pass ☐ fail ☐ partly

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Tool Log · Build It Twice

8 min

Name: _____ **My build:** _____

	Tool name	One thing it did well	One thing it got wrong	Passed my checks?
Tool 1				☐ yes ☐ no ☐ partly
Tool 2				☐ yes ☐ no ☐ partly

Which tool would you use for your final project, and why?

_____

_____

_____

Submit on MyCourses: a photo of this log **plus** a screenshot or link showing what you built.